

THE BLACK PANTHER

INTERCOMMUNAL NEWS SERVICE

PUBLISHED WEEKLY BY THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY

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VOL. XIV NO. 30

SATURDAY, APRIL 10, 1976

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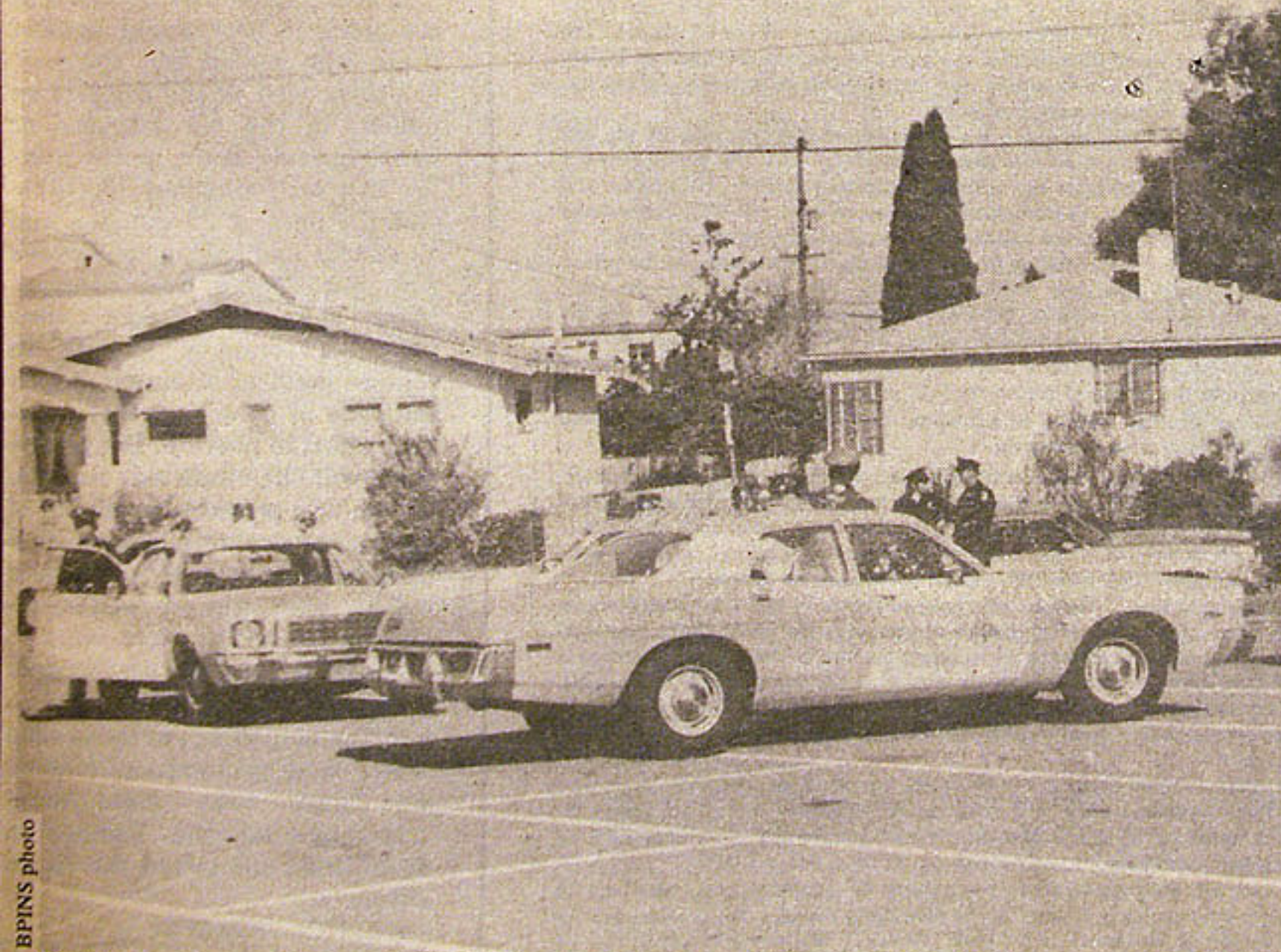
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(Oakland, Calif.) - The Oakland Community School (OCS), acknowledged as one of the most important models in elementary education in California by the state Department of Education and the recent recipient of a special Certificate of Commendation by the Alameda County Board of Supervisors, was the victim of unprovoked and unwarranted police harassment last week.

The incident, which took place on the morning of Tuesday, March 30, was seemingly instigated by unknown higher-ups in the much-maligned Oakland Police Department and crudely carried out by a group of 10 arrogant, foul mouthed patrolmen, plus an alleged woman officer. Thanks to the coolheaded and calm reactions of the staff of the OCS and the Oakland Community Learning Center (OCLC) present at the scene — who refused to react to the verbal threats and taunts from the police — the disruption was minimized.

According to the police patrolling the area, an alleged "stolen car" was spotted at the far edge of the Center's spacious parking lot around 8:15 a.m. (Later, the staff of the OCS reported that the unknown vehicle had not been there the night before.) Its presence that morning was of no particular concern to the early arriving staff — preparations for the first of the three free meals prepared daily for the 125 children who attend the OCS begin at 7:00 a.m. — since it is a common practice for neighbors to park their cars at the end of the lot

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Oakland police vehicles clutter Oakland Community School parking lot in an unsuccessful attempt to disrupt activities at the acclaimed five-year-old community-based school.

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